



PS5 SSD's unlocked

Sony will reportedly grant access to the M.2 SSD slot for storage expansion via firmware update. <http://digit.in/mar21-61>



NVIDIA RTX 3060

The new RTX 3060 cards have been launched in India and face similar availability to the RTX 3060Ti. <http://digit.in/mar21-62>

LG UltraGear 27GN950-B 144Hz 4K G-Sync Gaming Monitor

An all-rounder of sorts

LG's monitors have great panels and they attract a premium which in turn hurts market share in a price conscious market like India. LG has learnt of this fact and we saw them introduce monitors such as the 24GL600F which is a 24-inch 144 Hz FreeSync display that costs approximately 13K. A few more affordable units like this and LG could very well dominate the gaming monitor business in India. The monitor we're looking at is the more premium Ultragear 27GN950-B. An IPS high refresh-rate 4K HDR600 panel with FreeSync and G-Sync support.

Features

The LG UltraGear 27GN950-B comes with plenty of features that would appeal to gamers. The bezels are super thin, it's peak brightness can scale up quite a bit and the software suite is a great addition. There are three software that you do end up using. The first is LG UltraGear Control centre. This app is just about the RGB lighting effects pertaining to the strip on the back. The second app is called OnScreen Control and gives you access to the OSD (On Screen Display) controls within Windows. The last software is LG Calibration Studio and is very helpful for folks who want to use the monitor for media creation work aside from gaming. You will require a decent colorimeter to use the software. Coming to the gamer centric features, you don't get as much as what the competition provides. With the LG 27GN950-B you get a crosshair overlay with four different patterns and the ability to overclock the panel from 144 Hz to 160 Hz. The latter isn't that impactful.



Build Quality

The unit has a very gamer centric aesthetic which means you throw in a few red accents on a mostly black coloured unit. The screen is not curved and at 27-inches you don't see much of a difference in colour perception at the edges. On the front you have a flush panel with a very thin metal edge that juts out a little bit. The bezels are 5.5 millimeters on the top and both sides whereas the bottom bezel is 9.3 millimeters. These thin bezels make it a great choice for multi-monitor setups. Also, the screen has a matte anti-glare layer on top. Controls are on the bottom.

Performance

LG is known for their IPS panels, so we had great expectations from the monitor. The panel uses a simple RGB sub-pixel arrangement with W-LED backlighting. The colours post calibration are just incredible. We saw a fE of less than 0.4 which makes this very colour accurate. We usually look for 180 cd/m² and post calibration we ended up at 178 cd/m².

Colour temperature was at 6496 K and Gamma was at the usual 2.2.

Viewing angles are great thanks to the IPS panel. Colour washouts could be noticed around 40 degrees from either side, be it along the horizontal axis or the vertical axis. Colour shift was absolutely minimal and you had to view the panels from about 60 degrees on either side to notice any hue shift.

DR works great and the deep colour gamut is very much evident. We can see how content creators

might like this panel. And the panel can easily render gradients without much banding on the PC. Coming to the refresh rates, the panel has a native refresh rate of 144 Hz and you can push it up to 160 Hz. There's very low blur at 144 Hz and jumping to 160 Hz doesn't make that much of a difference.

The panel uses flicker-free backlighting and there's no Black Frame Insertion at play.

Verdict

The high refresh-rate coupled with HDR and great colour reproduction allow for great immersion and the low input lag is a huge plus for competitive gaming. LG can learn a thing or two from BenQ's Zowie monitors to make the monitor more gamer centric. The local dimming issue and the cloudiness are the only major problems that we had with the device, other than that, this is one heck of a gaming monitor.

—Mithun Mohandas

SPECIFICATIONS

MODEL: 27GN950-B | SCREEN SIZE: 27-inch | PANEL TYPE: IPS | RESOLUTION: 4K | BRIGHTNESS: 400 nits | REFRESH RATE: 144 Hz | INTERFACES: 2x HDMI, 1x DP, 2x USB, 1x Audio Out | ADAPTIVE SYNC: FreeSync, G-Sync | WEIGHT: 7.66 kg | WARRANTY: 1 year.

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